HOW TO USE

Local Media Downloader

Download public videos from YouTube, Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and X to your own PC, and optionally copy them to Google Drive.

5
Supported platforms

2 clicks
Start.bat to open, Stop.bat to close

STEP 1 Start the app

1

Install Docker Desktop (one time)

Download it from **docker.com/products/docker-desktop**, install it and open it once. Nothing else is needed: Python, FFmpeg and Node.js come inside the app.

2

Double-click Start.bat

It is in the app folder. The first start takes a few minutes to set up; after that it opens in seconds. Your browser opens **http://127.0.0.1:5000** automatically.

3

Double-click Stop.bat when you are done

Your videos, settings, history and Google sign-in are kept for next time.

The app runs only on your computer. Nobody else on the internet or your network can open it.

STEP 2 Download a video from a link

1

Open Download Queue

Use the menu on the left.

2 **Paste the link into Media URLs**

Under **Download from a link**. You can paste up to 20 links, one per line. Instagram reels, TikToks, Facebook videos, X posts and YouTube videos or playlists all work.

3 **Press Inspect and add to queue**

The app checks each link and adds the video to the queue. A message under the box tells you what was added or why a link was skipped.

4 **Press Start queue**

The queue is **paused every time the app starts**, so nothing downloads by surprise. Press **Start queue** and watch the progress bar.

STEP 3 Download a whole YouTube channel

1 **Open Channel Library**

Paste a channel link, an **@handle** or a playlist link and press **Fetch videos**.

2 **Pick the videos**

Search and filter the list, tick the videos you want (or **Select all matching**) and press **Download selected**.

3 **Start the queue**

Go to **Download Queue** and press **Start queue**. Videos download one at a time with a short pause between them, which keeps YouTube from blocking you.

STEP 4 Find your videos

Finished videos are listed on the **Local Files** page. On your PC they are saved in the **downloads** folder next to Start.bat, in one sub-folder per channel or creator:

```
downloads\
  The Channel Name\2024-05-01 - Video title [id].mp4
  creator_name\2026-02-11 - Video by creator_name [id].mp4
```

Want them somewhere else? Open the **.env** file in the app folder with Notepad, add a line such as **HOST_DOWNLOADS_DIR=D:/Videos**, save, then run Start.bat again.

A video that is already downloaded is never downloaded twice. To get a fresh copy, press **Re-download** on the Local Files page.

STEP 5 Copy videos to Google Drive (optional)

1 One-time Google setup

Drive uploads need free Google Cloud keys in the **.env** file (GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID, GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET, GOOGLE_API_KEY, GOOGLE_PROJECT_NUMBER). The User Guide in the app folder walks through it step by step. Run Start.bat again after adding them.

2 Connect and choose a folder

Open **Settings**, press **Connect Google Drive** and sign in, then press **Choose Drive folder...**.

3 Upload

By hand: on Local Files, tick videos and press **Upload selected to Drive**.
Automatically: in Settings, turn on **Upload automatically after each download** and press **Save settings**. Progress shows on **Upload Queue**.

Uploading never removes the video from your PC. The local copy always stays.

STEP 6 If something goes wrong

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Start.bat says Docker is not running	Open Docker Desktop, wait until it says **Engine running**, then run Start.bat again.
Nothing downloads	Press **Start queue** on Download Queue. The queue starts paused every time the app starts.
A yellow "requests are paused" banner appears	The site asked the app to slow down. Wait for the time shown in the banner, then press **Resume**.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
A link fails straight away	Private, deleted, login-only, age-restricted or region-blocked videos cannot be downloaded. The error message says which.
The page looks old or buttons do nothing	Press **Ctrl+F5** in the browser to reload the page.
A Drive upload failed	Open Upload Queue. Reconnect Google Drive in Settings if asked, then press **Retry**. The downloaded video is not affected.

Only download videos you own or have permission to save, and respect each platform's terms.